Kevin Yang Xiao

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SUMMARY

Game Design graduate student who shipped Icarian, a free arcade flying-combat game on Steam, as producer and programmer. Background in computer science and history, with QA and user-testing experience at Tencent and app development at Klipsch. Works in Unity and Unreal; comfortable running schedules, tracking tasks, and presenting results to external partners.

EDUCATION

Rochester Institute of Technology | *M.S. Game Design* — In progress

Skidmore College | *B.A. Computer Science; B.A. History* — Jan 2024

EXPERIENCE

Tencent | *QA Product Division Intern* — Jul 2025 – Aug 2025

- Supported QA and user-testing operations for international products, including the WeTest platform.
- Independently built a mobile app used to demonstrate the division's testing services to external partners.
- Delivered stable, reviewable Unity and Unreal demos in short iteration cycles for internal use, documenting issues.
- Assisted with test plan design, data collection, and feedback tracking across multiple development cycles.

Corner Seat Studios | *Co-founder & Lead Developer* — Mar 2020 – Present

- Build and publish games under fixed deadlines in recurring GMTK Game Jams; titles published on itch.io.
- Own programming, interaction design, UX, and overall project direction.
- 2023 GMTK Game Jam entry, Bowling But You Are The Pins, ranked among the top 100 most-rated submissions.

Klipsch | *Engineering Intern, Indianapolis, IN* — Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

- Developed a proof-of-concept feature for the Klipsch Connect app (500+ App Store ratings).
- Built tools using pink-noise generation and proprietary algorithms to calibrate audio to individual room acoustics.

Rayleigh Labs | *Market Research Intern; Public Relations Officer, Shenzhen* — Jun–Jul 2020; Jan–Jul 2024

- Researched consumer preferences for gaming audio and presented a trends report that informed launch of the OXS soundbar.
- Ran post-launch customer surveys on the soundbar's market reception.

GAME PROJECTS

Icarian | *Producer & Programmer, Two Artists (RIT capstone)* — Released May 2026

- Third-person arcade flying-combat game, released free on Steam by a small team.
- Programmed enemy AI and pathfinding, player controls, and the UI and menus.
- Designed combat arenas; sourced and implemented the game's sound effects.
- Ran production: timelines, task tracking, and milestone delivery through release.

Charon's Companion | *Tech Lead & Game Designer, RIT Production Studio*

- 3D adventure platformer about a cat navigating the underworld; exhibited at RIT's Imagine festival.

Gravebound | *Programmer, Level & Sound Designer, Team MAXXL* — Dec 2024

- Two-player co-op puzzle game in Unity built around a light-and-shadow mechanic; one player casts shadows the other must stay inside.

SKILLS

Engines: Unity, Unreal Engine
Production & QA: milestone planning, task tracking, build review, test planning, user testing, feedback reporting
Other: gameplay AI and pathfinding, player controls, UI and menus, level design, audio implementation, market research
Languages: English, Chinese